

Chapter 31 Part 3

After hanging up the video call, Xu Qingzhu reopened the study computer. The design drafts submitted by the design department were completely unusable now - they absolutely couldn't be presented as mature works at the launch event.

The autumn new product launch was imminent.

If this succeeded, Minghui Jewelry could still struggle on for a while longer, but if it failed, they'd probably have to declare bankruptcy within a few months.

The pressure on Xu Qingzhu's shoulders was enormous.

In desperation, she could only turn to former friends for help.

The person she'd just video-called was Sally, an American whose Chinese name was Yang Zhou.

When she first came to China, she really liked a poem line about "fireworks descending on Yangzhou in March," so she gave herself that Chinese name.

She had met her through the mountaineering club. Both she and Cherry were jewelry design students.

Back then in the mountaineering club, Xu Qingzhu had been the youngest.

Xu Qingzhu had never attended elementary school. Because of that kidnapping incident, she went through a long period of not speaking, just staying at home reading books.

Her father hired private tutors for her. Although she didn't speak, she could completely absorb what the teachers taught, and every time she took exams, her scores were extremely high.

Later, when her condition improved somewhat, her father directly arranged for her to take the middle school entrance exam. She started middle school at age ten, younger than all her classmates.

At that time she was also small in stature, sitting in the first row by the window. Everyone knew she had psychological issues, so no one dared play with her. All her joy came from reading books.

One year her old illness relapsed and she didn't go to school.

This was equivalent to repeating eighth grade for a year.

Later, she entered Haicheng No. 1 High School with high scores, then got into Qingyi University with high scores, majoring in finance.

When choosing her graduate direction, she pursued an MBA. She had received her marriage certificate with Liang Shi before even getting her hands on her two-year MBA degree certificate.

That's why Sally had been so surprised earlier.

When she got married back then, she had felt somewhat inferior, so she didn't notify too many friends from school.

She had even lost contact with everyone after graduation, only liking others' social media posts during holidays and New Year.

Sally and Cherry had each developed their careers after graduation. The two had been a very loving couple, but because Sally's mother became seriously ill during their graduation year, Sally's original plan to stay in the country was disrupted. Without discussing it with Cherry, she directly bought a ticket and flew back to America, which made Cherry angry enough to break up directly.

At the time, Xu Qingzhu had felt sorry for both of them.

It was only these past couple days that she had reconnected with Cherry.

Cherry's Chinese name was Lin Luoxi, currently the boss of Luoxi Studio.

If Minghui Jewelry hadn't reached such straits, Xu Qingzhu wouldn't have been able to bring herself to ask them for help.

Lin Luoxi's design talent was acknowledged as excellent. Her graduation project had been shortlisted for an international design competition and won third prize, once praised in the industry as a design genius with the nickname "Little Su Yao."

Many companies had extended olive branches to her, but Lin Luoxi only asked Xu Qingzhu, "Are you joining your family company?"

Xu Qingzhu said she planned to pursue graduate studies first and would decide later. Lin Luoxi went directly into entrepreneurship and told her, "Call me anytime if you need anything."

Lin Luoxi had attended her wedding and looked at Liang Shi with a complex expression, though she didn't say anything later.

She probably felt that it was a done deal - everyone had their own choices - so she just advised, "Keep your guard up."

Xu Qingzhu had already arranged to have dinner with Lin Luoxi tomorrow evening. She just hoped everything would go smoothly.

Looking at the design drafts on the computer screen, Xu Qingzhu frowned, her mind too chaotic to focus.

When had Liang Shi's English become so good?

After a long while, she sent a message to her psychiatrist, Dr. Gu Junru: [Dr. Gu, if someone has multiple personalities, would their skills change?]

Dr. Gu was still awake and replied immediately: [Be specific?]

Xu Qingzhu: [Her English used to be very poor, ignorant and uneducated, but now her English pronunciation is very standard and she can express some quite impressive viewpoints.]

Dr. Gu: [Is this about your wife?]

Xu Qingzhu: [...]

Dr. Gu quickly sent another message: [Dr. Zhao and I have discussed this issue and unanimously believe that professional examination is needed for confirmation.]

[Because multiple personalities could very likely involve memory segmentation, where one personality takes on her bad memories and certain abilities. But statistically speaking, the possibility of this happening is extremely remote, so further examination is needed.]

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What Liang Shi had wanted to discuss with Xu Qingzhu earlier was that since Xu Qingya had left their home, the two of them could live separately.

But seeing that Xu Qingzhu was busy, and she had just entered the company and was probably dealing with a complete mess, she didn't want to waste her time.

After leaving, Liang Shi sat on the sofa for a while. Feeling somewhat drowsy, she went upstairs to pack her things.

During her time at the villa, she had pretty much figured out all the rooms.

She really liked the second room from the left downstairs - bright and airy with good ventilation, spacious, and even had a walk-in closet.

So she planned to move there.

Liang Shi didn't have many belongings. Most of the clothes in the closet belonged to the original owner - all gaudy colors.

She had only bought a few pieces since transmigrating, so packing was convenient. Then there were the pillow and bedding.

That afternoon when Liang Shi returned, she had the servants put new sheets on that room and also place several spare sets of bedding and pillowcases.

However, she quite liked the set she'd been using, so she planned to take it downstairs.

Besides, Xu Qingzhu might not want to see her things left in the room.

Liang Shi planned to have the servants donate all those clothes in the closet tomorrow, to see which factory could recycle and remake these items.

She returned to the room and folded the bedding neatly, then stacked the pillow on top. The sheets had gotten wrinkled, so she simply remade the bed, and also folded Xu Qingzhu's bedding neatly and smoothly.

Xu Qingzhu had the habit of changing pillowcases daily. She felt that Xu Qingzhu would probably finish work quite late tonight, so after some hesitation, she took a new pillowcase from the closet, planning to help her change it.

But when Liang Shi picked up Xu Qingzhu's pillow, she was shocked.

There was a pair of scissors under her pillow.

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No wonder she was willing to sleep in the same bed with her - was she planning to use scissors if she was forced into anything?

Liang Shi felt a chill down her back.

This was quite ruthless too.

However, it made sense for Xu Qingzhu to keep scissors under her pillow for self-protection.

She helped Xu Qingzhu put on the new pillowcase, threw the old one in the laundry basket, and put the book that was on her bedside into the drawer. But when she opened the drawer, she saw a utility knife.

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Liang Shi felt that Xu Qingzhu wasn't just ruthless.

She was a wolf in sheep's clothing¹.

She didn't touch the other person's things, but wrote a note and stuck it on the bedside table, then turned on the bedside lamp on her side, adjusting it to an appropriate brightness. Before leaving, she also turned on the floor light by the door.

Footnotes:

¹ "Wolf in sheep's clothing" - The original Chinese "狼人" is a play on words between "狠人" (ruthless person) and "狼人" (werewolf/wolf person), suggesting someone even more extreme than just being ruthless.